

August 12, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Randall Stroman (MRN MUSC2600955), Claim MUSC-20260331-8F43-2

Patient	Randall Stroman (DOB 1956-10-18)
MRN	MUSC2600955
Member ID / Group	CIG204429254 / GRP-30566
Claim number	MUSC-20260331-8F43-2
Date of service	2026-03-31
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$482.20
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2026-10-24

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Randall Stroman (MRN: MUSC2600955, Member ID: CIG204429254, Group: GRP-30566) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260331-8F43-2 for services rendered on March 31, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. Cigna Healthcare denied the claim in full — \$482.20 billed — citing CARC 197 ("Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent") and RARC N54 ("Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services"), with the payer remark stating: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial on the grounds that prior authorization is not a contractually or clinically appropriate requirement for the service as billed, and that the denial does not align with standard coverage obligations for routine outpatient evaluation and management services.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Stroman is a 69-year-old established male patient with a documented history of multiple active chronic conditions, including hyperlipidemia, anemia, prediabetes, rheumatoid arthritis, and chronic sinusitis, as well as a presenting acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9) on the date of service. He was seen by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687) in an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22) for an established-patient office visit billed at CPT 99214, reflecting moderate medical decision-making complexity. Given Mr. Stroman's constellation of active chronic conditions requiring ongoing management alongside an acute presentation, the level of service reported is consistent with the documented complexity of his care. His medication regimen, including active Simvastatin therapy, further reflects the ongoing clinical management appropriate to his chronic disease burden.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

CPT code 99214 represents a standard outpatient evaluation and management service for an established patient. Under broadly accepted coding and coverage guidelines, routine evaluation and management visits — particularly for established patients presenting with acute illness in the context of multiple active chronic conditions — are not services that typically require prior authorization under commercial health plan benefit structures. Cigna's own plan documents for the Cigna Healthcare Choice Plus plan (coverage period 2024–2026) should be reviewed to confirm whether prior authorization is, in fact, listed as a requirement for CPT 99214 rendered in a Place of Service 22 setting. MUSC Health's records do not reflect any prior authorization requirement communicated by Cigna for this service category, and no such requirement was identified at the time of scheduling or service delivery.

Furthermore, RARC N54 indicates that claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified or authorized services, which presupposes the existence of a prior authorization. To MUSC Health's knowledge, no authorization was sought or denied — the service was rendered under the reasonable and good-faith understanding that outpatient evaluation and management for an established patient does not require precertification under this plan. If Cigna maintains that authorization was required, MUSC Health respectfully requests that the payer identify the specific benefit provision or utilization management policy that mandates precertification for this service, as this information was not made available to the provider prior to the date of service. Absent clear and accessible prior notification of such a requirement, holding the claim unpaid is inconsistent with fair claims processing standards and the provider's contractual rights.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare conduct a thorough review of this appeal and overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-20260331-8F43-2. Specifically, we request that the claim for CPT 99214, rendered on March 31, 2026, be reprocessed and paid at the contracted allowed amount of \$327.15. If Cigna determines that additional documentation is required to support this appeal, MUSC Health is prepared to provide the complete medical record for the date of service upon request. This appeal is submitted within the appeal deadline of October 24, 2026, through the appropriate channel as directed by Cigna.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record